

Final SEO Strategy

High-growth organic acquisition while preserving ACD's curated finance & investment positioning and clean user experience

Goal

Make Africa Career Desk dramatically easier to discover through Google while preserving what makes it valuable: curation, freshness, specialist African finance/investment positioning and a clean product.

Core principle: One clean product. Many useful search entrances.

North star: qualified organic discovery → opportunity browsing → job-detail engagement → Apply clicks → repeat/direct users.

1. What SEO must achieve

ACD is not trying to become Africa's largest generic job board. It aims to become a trusted discovery platform for high-quality African finance and investment careers.

SEO should maximize the number of high-intent searches for which ACD is genuinely one of the best destinations, not maximize indexed pages.

The strategy must never weaken curation, clutter the interface, create large manual maintenance, or encourage ACD to add weak jobs merely to fill SEO pages.

2. Four growth engines

Engine 1 - Opportunity SEO: make every live job technically excellent and discoverable.

Engine 2 - Curated discovery pages: selected category, employer and country/region pages generated from the same opportunity database.

Engine 3 - Authority & ecosystem distribution: universities, finance clubs, employers, professional networks and relevant industry organizations.

Engine 4 - Proprietary ACD intelligence: preserve structured historical hiring data now and later publish original African finance/investment hiring insights.

3. Engine 1 - Technical job SEO

- JobPosting structured data only on individual live job pages; markup must match visible content.
- Use Google's Indexing API only for eligible job-posting URLs, alongside a normal XML sitemap.
- Handle expired roles promptly and consistently; do not keep presenting closed roles as open.
- Maintain one canonical URL per opportunity and descriptive role/employer/location titles.
- Preserve mobile speed and the existing clean Apply experience.
- Monitor Search Console and structured-data errors continuously, not only during launch.

4. Engine 2 - Discovery-page hierarchy

Priority 1 - Category pages. These best express ACD's differentiated curation and usually have deeper inventory. Initial candidates: Private Equity/VC/Private Credit; Development Finance & Multilaterals; Infrastructure & Project Finance; Investment Banking & Corporate Finance; Climate & Impact when inventory supports it.

Priority 2 - Selected employer pages. Build the capability in the same technical wave as categories, but launch only recurring, audience-relevant employers with meaningful ACD coverage and plausible search demand.

Priority 3 - Selected country/region pages. Country pages remain important for queries such as investment jobs Nigeria or Kenya, but they must be genuinely useful destinations.

5. Country / region eligibility

Do not use a rigid rule such as '8-10 jobs or no page.' Five exceptional IFC/PE/DFI roles can be more useful than dozens of generic finance vacancies.

Stage 1 - Minimum real usefulness: would a real visitor landing today see a credible destination rather than an empty shell? One or two roles will usually fail this test.

Stage 2 - Strategic case: assess historical recurrence, search demand, market importance, distinctiveness and expected continuity.

Regional pages such as West Africa may sometimes be better than forcing a thin country page.

6. User experience and indexation

Keep the visible core simple: Jobs · Programmes · Open Applications · About. Discovery pages can be reached through Google, contextual links and a compact Explore experience.

Each discovery page should show a clear H1, concise scope, live opportunity count and familiar ACD job cards above the fold, plus a route to All Jobs.

Arbitrary filter URLs, country×category combinations, seniority and language combinations are not indexable by default. Promote them only after evidence of distinct demand and user value.

Do not add keyword-heavy essays, hidden crawler text, generic AI country copy or manually duplicated job lists.

7. Internal linking

Internal links should improve the product first and crawlability second.

Individual jobs should naturally connect to: more jobs in this category, more jobs in this country/region, more roles from this employer, and All Jobs.

Category/country/employer pages link back to normal job details and selectively to related discovery destinations.

Model: Individual Job ↔ Category ↔ Country/Region ↔ Employer ↔ All Jobs.

8. Engine 3 - Authority & distribution

ACD should not run a generic backlink campaign. It should become a resource relevant organizations genuinely want to share.

Priority channels: university/finance clubs, business-school career centers, African universities, employers, DFI/professional networks, investment associations and specialist newsletters.

Do not buy links, trade links for their own sake, or use unnatural keyword-optimized partner anchors. SEO benefit should follow genuine usefulness and distribution.

9. Engine 4 - Build the proprietary data moat now

Historical data lost today cannot always be reconstructed later. ACD should preserve an internal historical record even when expired jobs disappear from the public Jobs page.

- Stable job ID and stable normalized employer ID.
- First-seen and last-seen timestamps captured by ACD.
- Closure status/reason where reliably known.
- Structured country/city plus multi-location flag.
- Consistent category, role type, seniority/experience, language and work-arrangement fields.
- Outbound Apply-click events tied to job ID, employer ID and acquisition source.
- Do not collect compensation casually; salary intelligence needs a deliberate methodology.

10. Apply-click attribution

Before redirecting a user to an employer's official application page, ACD should record the click internally.

Capture job ID, employer ID, category, location, timestamp, ACD source page and acquisition source where available.

Do not automatically append UTM parameters to every employer URL. Internal ACD event tracking is sufficient for attribution; external UTMs can be added only where safe and appropriate.

This supports SEO measurement, employer relationships and future recruiter analytics.

11. Language strategy

ACD can remain English-first while carrying original French job titles/descriptions where appropriate.

French-language vacancies do not by themselves require hreflang. Hreflang becomes relevant if ACD later creates equivalent translated versions of the same landing pages, for example /en/ and /fr/.

Do not make multilingual architecture a blocker for the first SEO implementation. Reassess if search data shows meaningful demand for a French-language ACD experience.

12. Future proprietary ACD resources

ACD should publish a very small number of resources that only ACD is well positioned to produce - not a high-volume SEO blog.

Potential assets: State of African Investment & Finance Hiring; Africa Investment Hiring Map; geographic and functional hiring trends; language/seniority patterns; eventually credible compensation intelligence.

A small number of exceptional career guides may be useful, but content volume is never a KPI. Every resource should answer: why should this exist on ACD rather than anywhere else?

13. Implementation roadmap

Phase	Actions
Phase 1 - Foundation	Technical audit; JobPosting; expiry lifecycle; Indexing API guardrails; sitemap/canonicals; Search Console; Apply-click attribution; stable employer/job IDs; begin preserving historical data.
Phase 2 - First discovery wave	Build one reusable discovery-page engine. Launch strongest category pages and a small set of selected recurring employer pages. Add contextual internal linking.
Phase 3 - Geography	Launch only the strongest country/region pages that pass the two-stage usefulness + strategic test.
Parallel from Month 1	Begin ecosystem distribution with university/finance clubs, career centers, employers and relevant professional networks.
Months 4-6	Measure impressions, organic sessions, job-detail views and Apply clicks. Improve useful pages; do not kill them merely because ranking is slow.
Months 6-9	Expand proven page types selectively. Prepare the first ACD hiring-data asset from accumulated historical data.
Months 9-12	Publish/distribute the first proprietary market insight; review organic contribution to acquisition and scale only what demonstrates qualified value.

What waits

- Mass country×category pages.
- Seniority/language SEO pages.
- Large article libraries.
- Generic salary pages without credible data.
- Any SEO initiative requiring lower opportunity-quality standards.

14. Measurement framework

Level	Metrics
Search visibility	Non-branded impressions, strategic pages indexed, query coverage, position by query/page cluster
Traffic	Organic users/sessions, landing-page entries, new users from organic
Product quality	Job-detail views per organic session, browsing/filter engagement, return visits
Business intent	Apply clicks from organic, employer-page engagement, programme/open-application engagement
Authority	Relevant referring domains, partner/resource citations, earned mentions
Brand	Branded search growth, direct traffic growth, returning users
Guardrails	Page speed, stale jobs, zero-result pages, index bloat, UX clutter

Primary success metric

Qualified organic users who engage with relevant opportunities and generate Apply clicks - not raw traffic and not number of indexed pages.

15. Final strategic recommendation

Do SEO aggressively, but do not make ACD look aggressive about SEO.

The growth engine should be largely invisible to existing users: better job indexing, carefully chosen category/employer/country entrances, stronger contextual linking, ecosystem authority and a proprietary historical hiring dataset. The visible product stays curated and clean.

Implementation order

- 1. Technical job SEO, measurement and data preservation.
- 2. Category pages + selected employer pages + internal linking.
- 3. Selected country/region pages.
- 4. Ecosystem authority/distribution in parallel.
- 5. First proprietary ACD hiring-data asset.
- 6. Expand only from evidence.

Technical boundaries validated against current Google Search Central guidance on JobPosting structured data, the Indexing API, spam policies, sitemaps and canonicalization. Strategic choices remain ACD-specific.